

Addendum A

Student Government Association Board of Advisors

Preamble

Recognizing the importance of institutional continuity and the value of alumni engagement, the Stevens Student Government Association establishes the Board of Advisors of the Student Government Association, herein, referred to as “Board of Advisors” to serve as a strategic resource that preserves organizational memory and provides guidance for key initiatives. This Board is intended to support the long-term success and vision of the SGA by offering insights rooted in experience and connection to the Stevens community.

Article I. Mission and Purpose

The mission of the Board of Advisors is to preserve institutional memory and offer strategic guidance on major SGA initiatives. The Board of Advisors shall be comprised of SGA alumni whose backgrounds reflect a range of strengths, including institutional knowledge, personal impact, visionary leadership, and a commitment to mentorship. The Board of Advisors shall meet regularly as to review the SGA’s long-term vision, upcoming policy agenda, and progress on key projects.

Article II. Membership

2.1. Membership

The Board of Advisors shall consist of no fewer than four (4) and no more than ten (10) members, herein referred to as a “Board Member” or “Advisor”. Board Members hold no formal decision-making power within the SGA, existing to guide the organization on its long-term goals and strategically plan with its leadership. Board Members are bound by the restrictions set forth in this addendum.

2.2. Terms

Board Members serve for a standard term of three calendar years, starting at 12:00am on the first day of July.

2.3. Appointments

All appointments and reappointments of Board Members shall take place during a Board of Advisors meeting in the month of June. New Board Members shall be nominated and confirmed by a majority vote of the existing Board Members. At the conclusion of their term, Board Members may be considered for reappointment using the same nomination and confirmation process. There is no limit to the number of terms a Board Member may serve.

2.4. Vacancy Terms

A Board Member confirmed at a non-June meeting shall be considered to have started their term as if they were elected at the previous June meeting unless they are filling a seat once held by another Board Member, in which case, their term shall end when the previous Board Member's was slated to end.

2.5. Restrictions

No more than two (2) Board Members may be from the same SGA graduating class year at any given time. At least two (2) Board Members should be alumni who graduated ten (10) or more years prior to their appointment. This shall only apply when considering the appointment or re-appointment of Board Members.

2.6. Suspension of Restrictions

If, after a good-faith effort to recruit qualified alumni following the restrictions outlined in Section 2.5. is followed and no suitable candidates express interest; the Board of Advisors may temporarily waive this requirement by a two-thirds vote and approval from the SGA President. The waiver must be re-evaluated annually during the June meeting.

Article III. Structure

3.1. Point of Contact

The SGA President shall serve as the primary point of contact with the Board of Advisors. The SGA President is responsible for communicating updates, coordinating meetings, and ensuring the Board of Advisors is kept informed of major developments within the SGA, including but not limited to the following:

1. Changes in leadership including but not limited to changes in Cabinet members, commencement of a new Session of Senate, and election of a new Senate Speaker.
2. Progress of all Cabinet initiatives.
3. Updates regarding SAF budgeting.

3.2. Chairperson

The Board of Advisors shall elect a Chairperson from among its members at the January meeting each calendar year. In the event of a vacancy, a Chairperson shall be elected at the next scheduled meeting to serve the remainder of the term. The Chairperson shall:

1. Preside over meetings of the Board of Advisors and coordinate meeting agendas with the SGA President.
2. Serve as the primary liaison between the Board of Advisors and the SGA President.
3. Lead discussions and facilitate Board of Advisors operations in conjunction with the SGA President.
4. Oversee the onboarding of new Board Members in collaboration with the SGA President.
5. Serve a one-year term and may be re-elected without limitation. A Chairperson elected in a vacancy election will serve until the end of the outlined term. The Chairperson may not be elected during their final year as a Board Member.

3.3. Meetings

The Board of Advisors shall convene at least five (5) times per calendar year. One meeting shall occur at the beginning of the calendar-year to (1) elect a new Chairperson, and (2) receive presentations from all Cabinet members outlining their initiatives, including a proposed annual budget from the Vice President of Finance. Another meeting shall be held in June for the purpose of Board Member appointments, reappointments, and internal planning. The SGA President and Cabinet shall engage with the Board of Advisors regularly, seeking its insight on strategic decisions. Meetings may be held virtually or in person and shall be scheduled by the Chairperson of the Board in collaboration with the SGA President. Additional meeting structure and topics shall be decided on and outlined in the Bylaws of the Board of Advisors as denoted in Article VII.

Article IV. Resignation and Removal

4.1. Resignations

Members may resign at any time by providing written notice to both the Chairperson of the Board and the President of the SGA. In their written notice, Board Members must specify the date of their resignation.

4.2. Impeachments

Should a Board Member violate any of the rules outlined in this addendum or additional governing documents for the Board of Advisors, they are subject to impeachment. Any Board Member or Cabinet member may raise an impeachment against any Board Member. All raised impeachments shall be directed to the President of the SGA who will then call for a meeting to discuss it with the Board of Advisors. The Board of Advisors may vote to remove an impeached official with a 4/5 affirmative vote.

4.3. Vacancy Nominations

In the event of a resignation or removal, the Chairperson of the Board, in consultation with the President, may call for the appointment of a replacement Board Member.

Article V. Operations and Procedures

5.1. Quorum

A majority of Board Members shall constitute a quorum for all meetings.

5.2. Minutes

Meeting minutes and summaries shall be documented and archived by the Chairperson of the Board and made available to the entirety of the SGA no later than one week after the conclusion of the meeting.

Article VI. Code of Conduct

Board Members are expected to uphold the SGA values in all interactions with members of the SGA and the Stevens community. All discussions, especially regarding student concerns or internal conflict resolution, shall be treated with discretion and professionalism. Board Members may not use their position for personal or political gain.

Article VII. Bylaws of the Board of Advisors

The Board of Advisors shall be provided with a set of Bylaws by the SGA to be approved by the Senate through a piece of legislation with a majority vote. The Bylaws of the Board of Advisors may be edited following the amendment process listed within them. The Rules Committee of the SGA shall check all amendments to the Bylaws of the Board of Advisors to ensure there are no conflicts between the amendment and any existing governing documents of the SGA. No rule defined in the Board of Advisors Bylaws, or any other governing document of their creation may supersede or be inconsistent with the rules outlined in this addendum.

Bylaws of the Board of Advisors

Article I. Purpose

These Bylaws govern the internal operations of the Board of Advisors of the Student Government Association. The Board exists as an advisory body to the Student Government Association, with authority and structure defined in the official Addendum to the SGA Bylaws. These Board of Advisor Bylaws are intended to complement the Addendum and provide additional detail for the Board's operations, logistics, and internal governance.

Article II. Nominations and Appointments

2.1. Initiation

The Board shall initiate the appointment process of New Board Members no later than May 1 each year in preparation for the June meeting.

2.2. Application Form

An open call for applications shall be distributed to the SGA alumni network, graduating SGA class, and relevant campus stakeholders. This application period must remain open for a minimum of two (2) weeks. Applicants must submit a resume and a brief statement of interest outlining their qualifications and SGA involvement. The Board may choose to conduct interviews or request additional materials.

2.3. Review of Applications

The Chairperson shall compile all applications and distribute them to the Board at least one week prior to the June meeting to determine appointees.

2.4. Approval

Appointments and reappointments shall be confirmed by a 2/3 affirmative vote of the Board Members during the June meeting.

Article III. Membership Expectations

3.1. Attendance

All Board Members shall attend at least four (4) of the five (5) scheduled meetings. Members unable to attend a meeting should notify the Chairperson in advance and, when appropriate, submit written comments for all Board of Advisors business in lieu of attendance.

3.2. Participation

All Board Members shall review relevant materials prior to a meeting. Any and all discussions shall be held with discretion, integrity, and respect. Board Members shall also serve as mentors to the Officials of the SGA.

Article IV. Officers

4.1. Chairperson

The Board shall elect a Chairperson from among its members annually, in accordance with the process and timing outlined in the Student Government Association Board of Advisors Addendum. The Chairperson shall maintain all duties as outlined in the Student Government Association Board of Advisors Addendum.

4.2. Additional Officers

The Board may, by majority vote, elect or appoint additional officers (e.g., Vice Chair, Secretary) as needed to fulfill its responsibilities.

Article V. Annual Meeting Calendar

5.1. Purpose

The following article outlines the meeting schedule for the Board of Advisors, including who should be present at the various meetings, and what topics each meeting should focus on.

5.2. January

The January meeting shall consist of the Board of Advisors, the newly elected President and their Cabinet for the SGA along with the previous President and their Cabinet for the SGA. The meeting shall focus on transition of leadership, presentation of annual goals by incoming Cabinet, and election of new Chairperson.

5.3. April/May

A meeting shall be scheduled during the months of April or May. All Board Members and the entire SGA Cabinet are required to attend. The meeting shall focus on Spring semester updates, summer plans, and a preview of Fall semester budget.

5.4. June

The June meeting is reserved specifically for Board Members and shall be used for Board Member nominations, appointments, reappointments, and internal planning. The Chairperson reserves the right to invite the SGA Cabinet to the June meeting at their discretion.

5.5. August

During the month of August, Board Members and the SGA Cabinet shall meet to discuss the SGA Strategic Plan, including any recommended actions or revisions, and the Cabinet academic-end-year report.

5.6. October/November

A meeting shall be scheduled during the months of October or November. All Board Members and the entire SGA Cabinet are required to attend. The meeting shall focus on reviewing any updates from the Fall Semester, and preparations for the Spring Semester including budgeting and programming.

5.6. Additional Meetings

As defined in the SGA Board of Advisors Addendum, the Chairperson and SGA President may collaboratively decide to call more meetings than those listed above.

Article VI. Voting

6.1. Voting Requirement

All decisions, unless otherwise specified, requiring a vote shall be passed by a simple majority of those present.

6.2. Voting Location

Voting may take place in person, virtually, or asynchronously as determined by the Chairperson.

Article VII. Amendments

Any Board Member may propose an amendment to these Bylaws. Proposed amendments must be submitted in writing at least one week in advance of a scheduled meeting. All proposed amendments must be ratified by 2/3 of Board Members and approved following the procedure outlined in the SGA Board of Advisors Addendum. The Board shall review its Bylaws at least once every two (2) years to ensure continued relevance and alignment with SGA goals.

Article VIII. Adoption

These Bylaws shall take effect immediately upon ratification by the Senate of the SGA.